

SIX QUESTIONS · ABOUT FIVE MINUTES · BEFORE ANY NEW TOOL TOUCHES YOUR PRACTICE

Is this AI tool safe for my classroom?

Run every new tool through these six questions before it gets near your planning, your students, or your data. A tool that fails one of the first three is a stop, not a maybe.

- ☐ **1 · Is it approved by my district?** Check the approved-tools list, or ask whoever owns it. Not on the list? Bring it to your administrator before using it with anything school-related. Asking first is faster than unringing a bell.
- ☐ **2 · What happens to what I type?** Skim the privacy policy for two things: whether your inputs are used to train the model, and whether data is sold or shared. If you can't tell in five minutes of looking, treat the answer as "yes, everything."
- ☐ **3 · Would students need accounts?** Student logins mean student data: names, emails, usage records. That requires district-level agreements, not a teacher's judgment call. If the tool needs student accounts and no agreement exists, keep it teacher-side only.
- ☐ **4 · Do the tool's own terms allow my students?** Most general-purpose AI chatbots set a minimum age in their terms of use, and many require parental consent under 18. A tool whose own rules exclude your students has answered the question for you.
- ☐ **5 · Can I get the value teacher-side only?** Most classroom wins (drafting, leveling, planning, feedback language) work with the teacher at the keyboard and placeholders instead of names. If teacher-side use gets you 90% of the value with none of the student-data risk, start there.
- ☐ **6 · Does it help students learn, or do the work for them?** A tool that scaffolds thinking earns its place. A tool whose main use is producing finished student work is an academic-integrity conversation, not a classroom tool.

WHATEVER THE TOOL, THE RULE RIDES ALONG

Never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool.
And a human reviews everything before it reaches a student or family.

Quick scoring: six clear yeses, use it with confidence. A wobble on 4, 5, or 6: proceed teacher-side while you check. Any doubt on 1, 2, or 3: stop and ask first.

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